

# Take-From and Comparison Stories Within Ten

## Answer Key

Kindergarten–Grade 1    Operations and Algebraic Thinking

### Quick Answers

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|------|------|------|---------|
| 1. 4 | 3. 3 | 5. 4 | 7. 6    |
| 2. 5 | 4. 5 | 6. 4 | 8. 5, 3 |

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### Curriculum

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**Level:** Kindergarten–Grade 1    Operations and Algebraic Thinking

K.OA.A / 1.OA.C.6 / 2.OA.B.2 – *problems 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8*

*Difficulty 1–4 of 5 across 9 tagged checks.*

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### Common wrong answers

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- 3. *If they got 11: added the two groups instead of finding how many more*
  - 4. *If they got 3: wrote the number of grapes eaten instead of the number left*
  - 5. *If they got 14: counted every animal in the story instead of comparing the two groups*
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#### 1. 6 crayons, 2 given away.

**Step 1.** This is a take-from story: the crayons that leave are gone, so the count goes down. Start with 6 and cross out 2.

**Step 2.** Count only the crayons with no cross on them: 4 crayons remain, so  $6 - 2 = 4$ .

4 crayons

*What to listen for:* the child should say the unit — “four crayons” — not just the number.

#### 2. 9 stickers, 4 used.

**Step 1.** Take-from again. The 4 stickers Ana uses come off the page of 9.

**Step 2.** Cross out 4 of the 9 stars and count the rest:  $9 - 4 = 5$ .

5 stickers

*Counting-on check:* from 4, count up to 9 — 5, 6, 7, 8, 9 — that is 5 counts, the same answer reached the other way.

#### 3. 7 red cubes and 4 blue cubes: how many more red?

**Step 1.** Nothing is taken away here. The two rows are matched one to one, and the question asks for the leftovers in the longer row.

**Step 2.** Four red cubes pair off with the four blue cubes. The red cubes with no partner are the answer:  $7 - 4 = 3$ .

3 more red cubes

*Why subtraction fits a comparison:* the matched pairs are removed from the bigger group in thought, not in fact. The cubes are all still there.

**4. 8 grapes, 3 eaten.**

**Step 1.** Take-from. Draw 8 dots for the grapes, then cross out 3.

**Step 2.** The uncrossed dots are the grapes still on the plate:  $8 - 3 = 5$ .

5 grapes

*Watch the question:* it asks what is *still on the plate*, not how many were eaten.

**5. 9 frogs and 5 ducks: how many fewer ducks?**

**Step 1.** A comparison, asked in the “fewer” direction. Matching a duck to a frog leaves some frogs unmatched, and that gap is the answer either way you name it.

**Step 2.** Bigger group minus smaller group:  $9 - 5 = 4$ .

4 fewer ducks

*Same gap, two sentences:* there are 4 fewer ducks than frogs, and also 4 more frogs than ducks. Both describe the same matching.

**6. 10 buttons in a jar, 6 left: how many were taken?**

**Step 1.** Take-from with the middle of the story missing. The equation is  $10 - \square = 6$ , so the unknown is the amount removed.

**Step 2.** Ask “10 take away what leaves 6?” Count back from 10 to 6 — 9, 8, 7, 6 — that is 4 counts.

4 buttons

*Check by putting them back:*  $6 + 4 = 10$ , the number the jar started with.

**7. Sam has 9 shells, which is 3 more than Tia.**

**Step 1.** A comparison with the smaller group unknown. Tia’s shells plus the 3 extra shells make Sam’s 9, so  $\square + 3 = 9$ .

**Step 2.** Draw Sam’s 9 shells, circle the 3 extra, and count what is left outside the circle:  $9 - 3 = 6$ .

6 shells

*The classic error:* adding 3 to 9. “More” in the sentence describes Sam, not the operation — Tia is the *smaller* group, so her number must come out below 9.

**8. Challenge: 8 apples, 3 eaten, 2 pears.**

**Step 1.** Part (a) is take-from: the eaten apples leave the bowl, so  $8 - 3 = 5$  apples remain.

5 apples

**Step 2.** Part (b) is a comparison, and it uses the answer from part (a) rather than the starting 8. Match the 2 pears against the 5 apples that are actually in the bowl now.

**Step 3.**  $5 - 2 = 3$ , so three apples have no pear to pair with.

3 more apples

*Where two-step problems go wrong:* comparing the pears with the original 8 apples gives 6 and ignores the eating. Finish step one, write its answer down, and only then start step two.